RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

# Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:54 AM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 186 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 48 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,830 minutes at 12:00 PM (no movements since HZA8 at 4:33 AM); Dammam moving, no halt since 6:01 AM

INCIDENT SUMMARY

## 1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,830 minutes at 12:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No Riyadh takeoffs or landings since the 9:00 AM edition; last movement non-airline HZA8 to Heraklion at 4:33 AM, last landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday.
- 186 Wednesday Riyadh flights already cancelled (29%).
- No new attack or Civil Defense alert reported since the coalition intercepted 5 drones over the Madinah and Eastern regions from 6:52 AM.
- Yemen's central bank in Aden ordered assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships frozen (Al Ekhbariya, 10:28 AM).
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 6:01 AM; 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM, latest Gulf Air GF104 to Bahrain at 11:47 AM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13825 min).

| 186 | 0/0 | 4 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

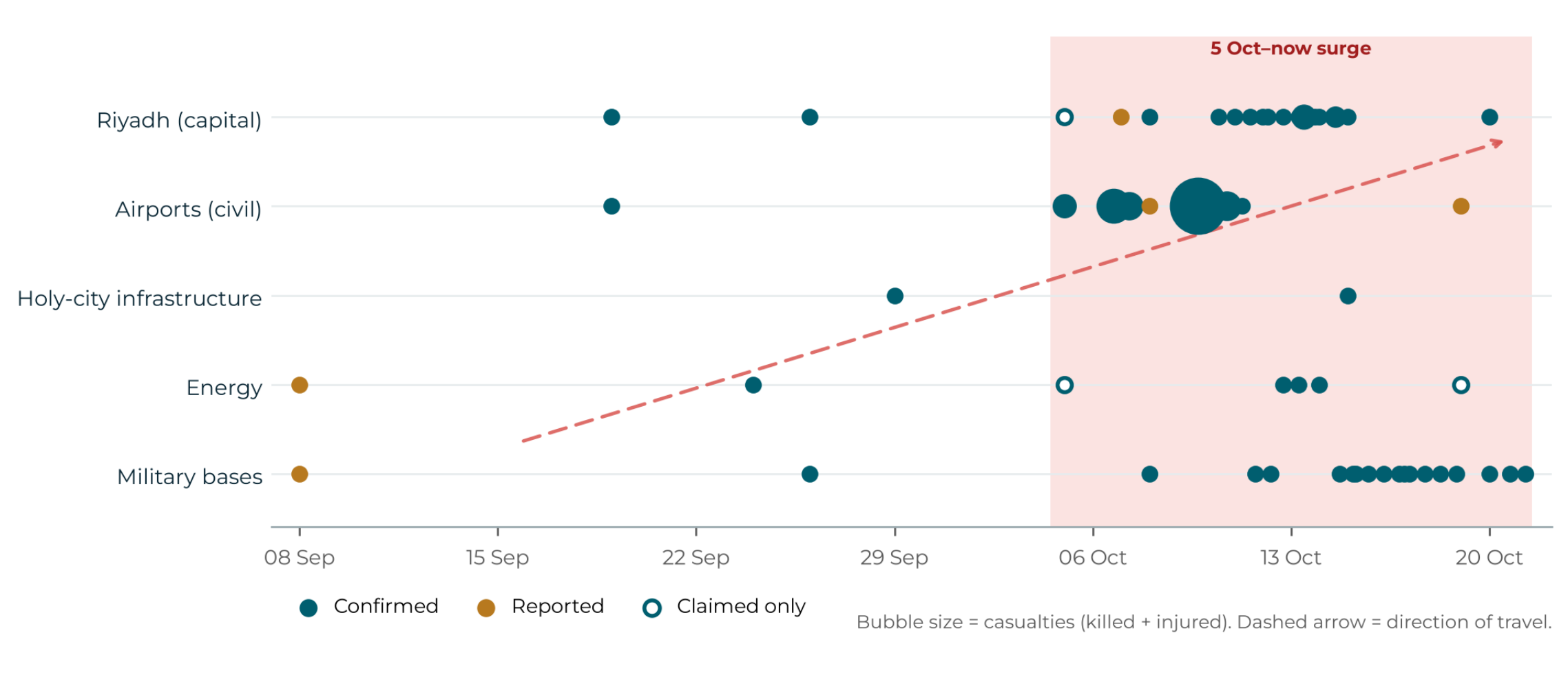
2 takeoffs and 4 landings in the last hour.

| 48 | 2/4 | 0 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,830 min at 12:00 PM); no takeoffs or landings since the 9:00 AM edition
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert reported in Saudi Arabia since 9:00 AM
- Yemen's central bank in Aden ordered assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships frozen (10:28 AM)
- Iran says Saudi Arabia has not answered its offer to mediate with the Houthis (Al Arabiya English, 10:01 AM; claim)
- Dammam moving with no halt; 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



Bubble size = casualties (killed + injured). Dashed arrow = direction of travel.

*56 sourced events since 8 September (48 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: a drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed; target not stated, no damage or casualties reported (21 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.*

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

## 2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 9:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

**No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 9:00 AM AST.**

**Last 24 hours: Interceptions 3.**

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

## 3 Riyadh still halted; Yemen's central bank freezes Houthi-linked assets; Dammam moving

Checked at 11:58 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's central bank orders freeze of accounts and assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **10:28 AM** · published 10:28 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 11:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's central bank in Aden issued directives to freeze the accounts, funds and assets of 135 individuals, entities and vessels linked to the Houthi militia. No list of names was published in the post.

CLAIM **Iran says Saudi Arabia has not yet answered its offer to mediate with the Houthis**

Al Arabiya English (@AlArabiya_Eng) · **10:01 AM** · posted 10:01 AM AST Wed 21 Oct, quoting Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi; no Saudi comment; checked 11:58 AM

Al Arabiya English quoted Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi as saying Saudi Arabia has not yet responded to Iran's offer to mediate between the Kingdom and the Houthis. Riyadh has made no public statement on the offer.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: another drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:58 AM** · published 6:58 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 AM; checked 8:56 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Malki said a further drone launched toward the Eastern Region was intercepted and destroyed, minutes after the four-drone announcement. No damage or casualties were reported.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four drones launched toward Saudi Arabia intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah and Eastern regions**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:52 AM** · published 6:52 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 and 7:28 AM, also Al Ekhbariya, Arab News; checked 8:56 AM

The coalition said four drones launched toward the Kingdom were intercepted and destroyed, and that the interceptions took place in the Madinah and Eastern regions. It did not say who launched them or report any damage or casualties.

CONFIRMED **Aden: growing numbers of people displaced fleeing Houthi fire**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:23 AM** · published 5:23 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported a rising number of people arriving in Aden after fleeing fire from the Houthi militia. No figures were given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi ambassador to Yemen: the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory; Taiz will not be held hostage**

Saudi Ambassador Mohammed Al Jaber via SABA (Yemeni state news agency) · **4:20 AM** · posted 4:20 AM AST Wed 21 Oct via the Yemeni Embassy in Pakistan's account quoting SABA; checked 5:58 AM

Saudi Ambassador to Yemen Mohammed Al Jaber said the Houthi militia trades on Yemenis' suffering, that Yemen does not belong to it and that Taiz will not be held hostage to its project, adding that the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory.

CONFIRMED **UN calls for aid access to besieged Taiz; Yemen's endowments ministry calls the Houthi siege a crime**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:39 AM** · published 3:39 AM and 4:17 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that the United Nations is calling for humanitarian aid to be allowed into Taiz province, which is besieged by the Houthis. Yemen's Ministry of Endowments told the channel the siege is a crime with no religious, customary or legal basis, and thanked Saudi Arabia for facilities given to Yemeni pilgrims.

UNVERIFIED **Unconfirmed reports of Houthi-Saudi border clashes near Jazan**

X account @MEBriefNews · **3:51 AM** · posted 3:51 AM AST Wed 21 Oct; described by the poster as preliminary, no Saudi or coalition confirmation and no independent outlet reporting a crossing; checked 5:58 AM

An X news account reported preliminary claims of clashes between Houthi supporters and Saudi forces along the border, raising the possibility of a crossing into Jazan. No authority has confirmed it; the only verified material is Houthi video of drone strikes on Saudi border positions in Jizan and Asir released Tuesday evening.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 200 Houthi fighters neutralised and 90 vehicles destroyed or disabled**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:45 AM** · published 2:45 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); figures are the Yemeni forces' own, not independently verified; checked 2:56 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya, citing Yemen's government armed forces, reported that about 200 Houthi fighters were neutralised and 90 vehicles and pieces of military equipment destroyed or disabled. No location or time frame was given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Cabinet: regional stability and freedom of navigation are an international responsibility**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:59 AM** · published 12:59 AM AST Wed 21 Oct in Al Ekhbariya's Tuesday roundup (translated from Arabic); checked 2:56 AM

Al Ekhbariya's roundup of Tuesday's news led with the Cabinet saying that strengthening regional stability and keeping navigation secure is an international responsibility, alongside the destruction of the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

## 4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13825 min).

| 186 | 4:33 AM | 7:51 PM | 0 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 90 departures + 96 arrivals, 29% of 632 scheduled. | HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 441 min before 11:54 AM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM. | SV979 from Guangzhou, 963 min before 11:54 AM. | 0 landings in the last hour. | Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:54 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 172 at 11:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 90 | 96 | 186 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 83 (26%) | 89 (29%) | 172 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 1 (0%) | 2 (1%) | 3 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 4 (80%) | 1 (33%) | 5 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 10 min | 700 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 3 of 145 | 0 of 119 | 3 of 264 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 4 | 4 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 34 | 33 | 67 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 175 | 180 | 355 | FR24 stats panel |

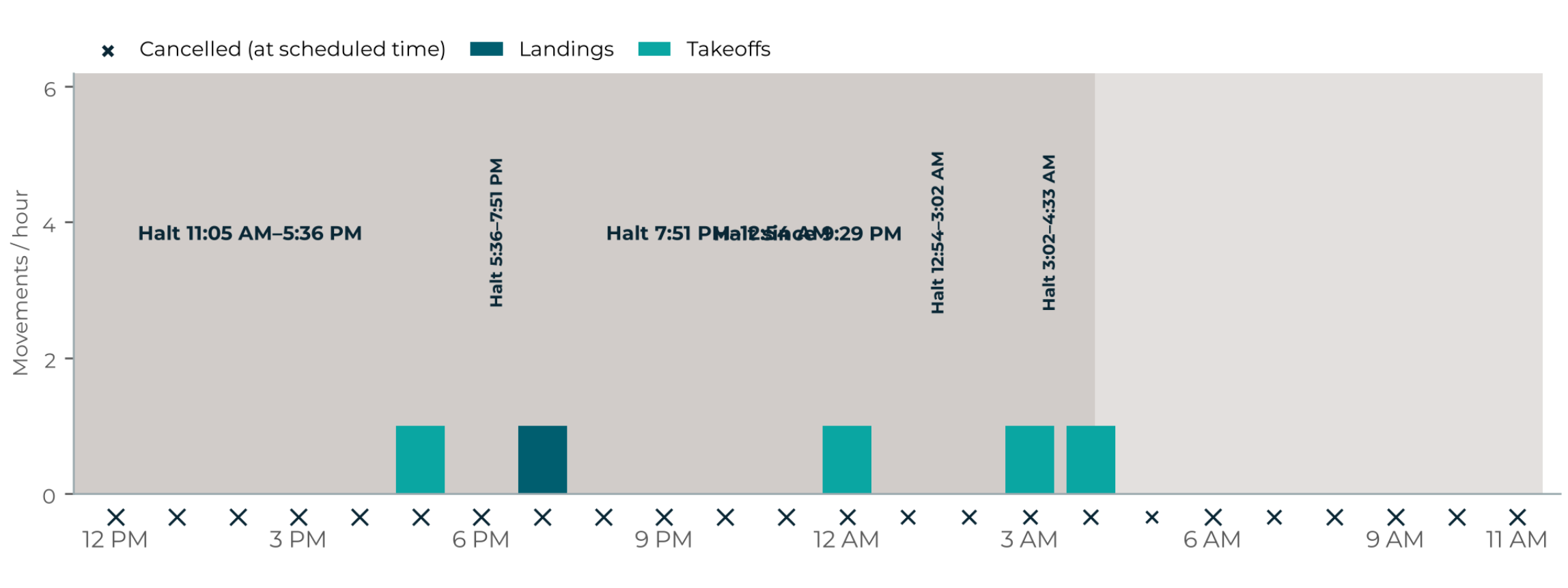
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| Saudia | 117 |
|---|---|
| Gulf Air | 10 |
| flynas | 7 |
| flyadeal | 7 |
| Emirates | 6 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| Jeddah | 23 |
|---|---|
| Madinah | 18 |
| Dubai | 17 |
| Bahrain | 12 |
| Dammam | 11 |

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



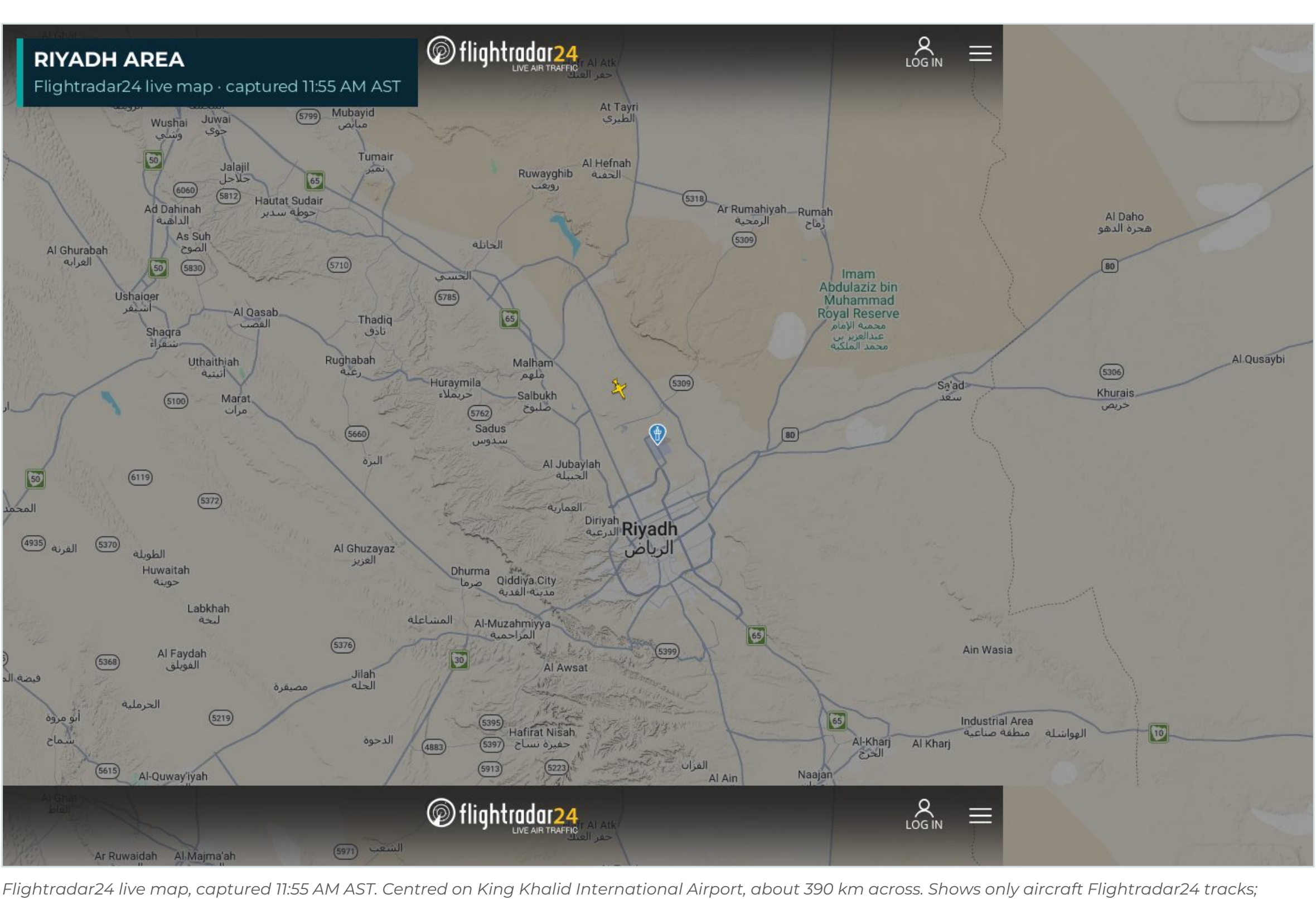
*Recorded takeoffs (4) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 12:00 PM Tuesday to 11:54 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: takeoffs HZSK5 to Geneva 11:05 AM and 0S2828 to Milan 5:36 PM Tuesday, Saudia SV992 12:54 AM, Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM Wednesday, and the landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 7:43–8:37 PM Tuesday, 1:45–2:55 AM, and 3:58–6:01 AM Wednesday (ended when Air Arabia G9161 took off).

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| Halt 3:02–4:33 AM | 91 min |
|---|---|
| Halt 12:54–3:02 AM | 128 min |
| Halt 7:51 PM–12:54 AM | 303 min |
| Halt 5:36–7:51 PM | 135 min |
| Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM | 391 min |

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

## 5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 2 takeoffs and 4 landings in the last hour.

| 48 | 11:47 AM | 11:31 AM | 2 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 23 departures + 25 arrivals, 21% of 229 scheduled. | GF104 to Bahrain, 7 min before 11:54 AM. | XY765 from Tabuk, 23 min before 11:54 AM. | 4 landings in the last hour. | None recorded today. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:54 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 46 at 11:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 23 | 25 | 48 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 22 (19%) | 24 (21%) | 46 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 8 (7%) | 4 (4%) | 12 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 17 (68%) | 13 (76%) | 30 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 7 min | 5 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 27 of 47 | 19 of 45 | 46 of 92 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 0 | 0 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 11 | 8 | 19 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 32 | 32 | 64 | FR24 stats panel |

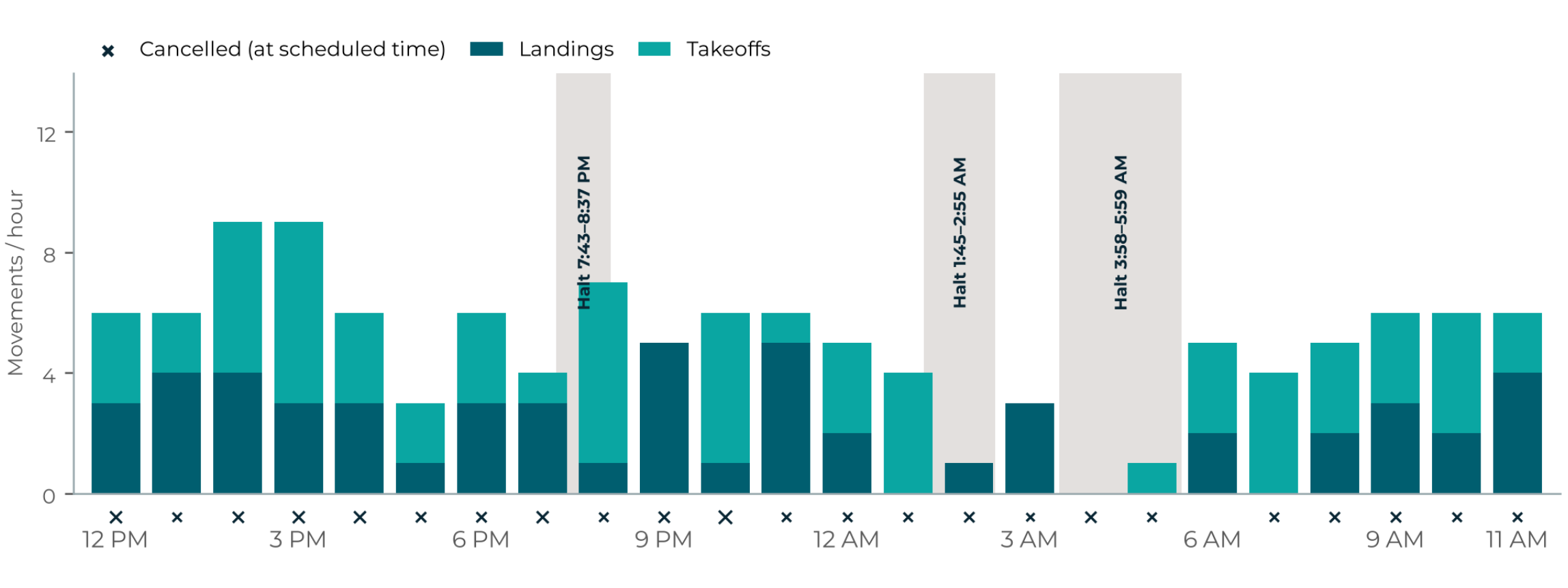
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| Saudia | 11 |
|---|---|
| Egyptair | 8 |
| Etihad Airways | 8 |
| flydubai | 8 |
| Emirates | 6 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| Dubai | 14 |
|---|---|
| Riyadh | 11 |
| Abu Dhabi | 8 |
| Cairo | 6 |
| Madinah | 3 |

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



*Recorded takeoffs (64) and landings (55) at DMM per hour from 12:00 PM Tuesday to 11:54 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Moving: 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM, 2 takeoffs and 4 landings in the last hour; no halt since 6:01 AM.

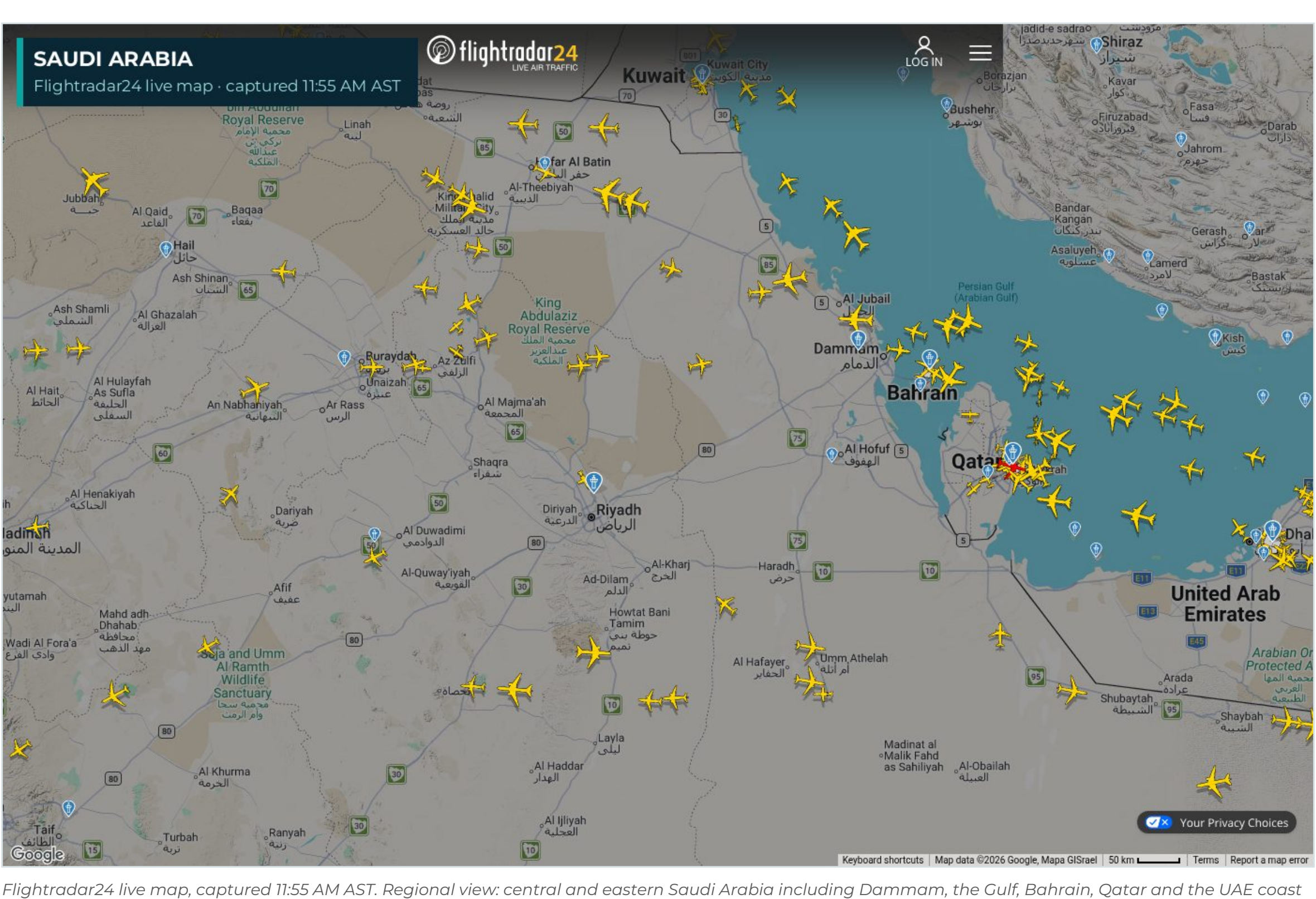
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| Halt 3:58–5:59 AM | 120 min |
|---|---|
| Halt 1:45–2:55 AM | 70 min |
| Halt 7:43–8:37 PM | 54 min |

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (11:58 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



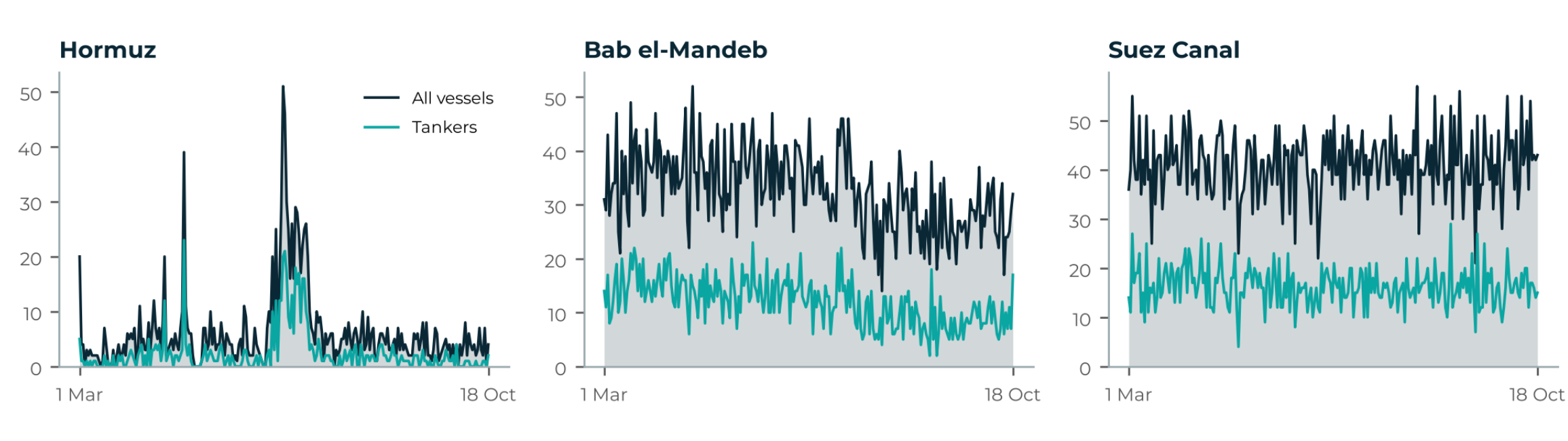
*Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

ECONOMY

## 6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

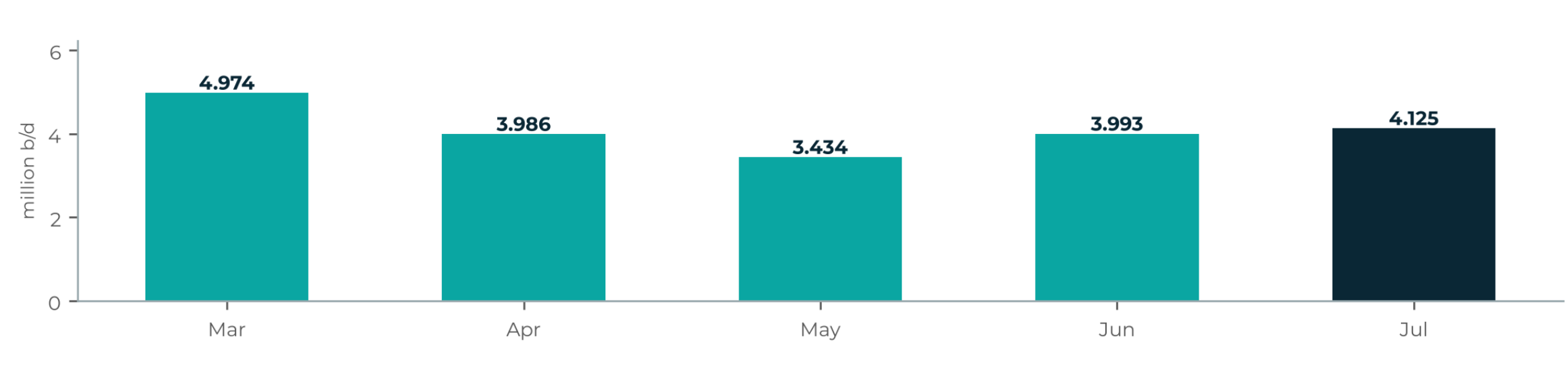
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

| CHOKEPOINT | LATEST DAY | ALL VESSELS | TANKERS | OTHER SHIPS | 7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hormuz** | Sun 18 Oct | **4** | 2 | 2 | 3.7 (4.1) |
| **Bab el-Mandeb** | Sun 18 Oct | **32** | 17 | 15 | 26.4 (28.3) |
| **Suez Canal** | Sun 18 Oct | **43** | 15 | 28 | 44.3 (41.7) |



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 11:56 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

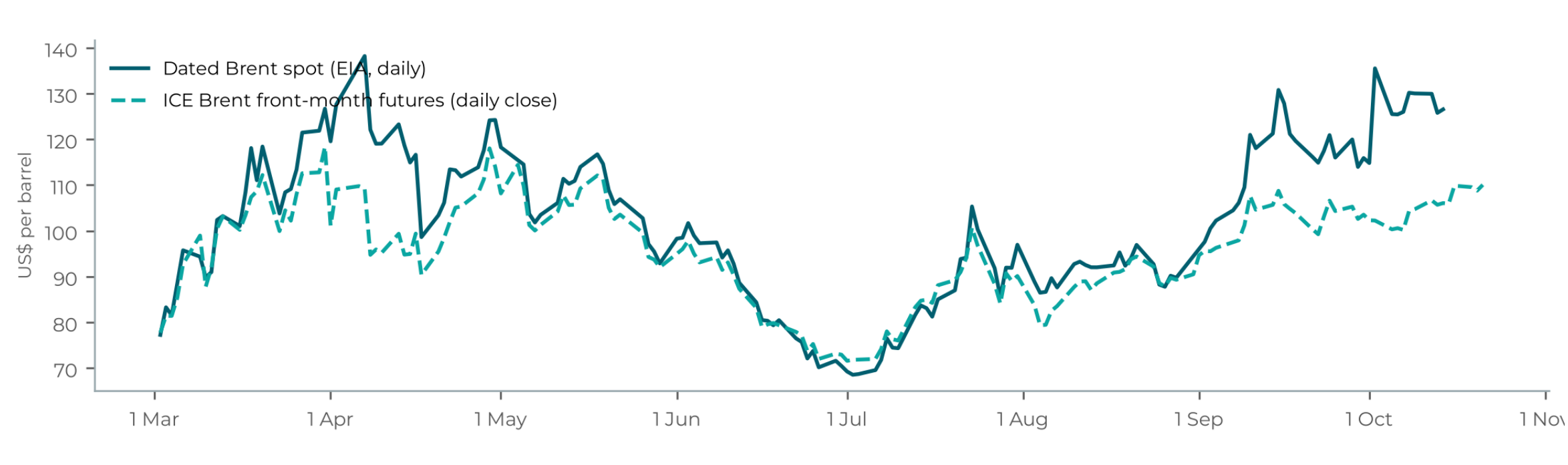


**Monthly, lagged about two months.** Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

*Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).*

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

| $110.05 | $126.55 | +4% | +64% |
|---|---|---|---|
| BRENT FUTURES, LATEST | DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA) | SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE | SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH |
| ICE front-month, 11:45 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+1.2% on day). Near real time. | Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days. | From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep. | From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr. |



*Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.*

METHOD AND LIMITS

## 7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:54 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

| PREPARED | BOARD DATA AS OF | SOURCES | STATUS | HANDLING | NEXT UPDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11:54 AM, Wed 21 Oct | 11:54 AM | Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA | **RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted** | Open sources · not official | 3:00 PM |

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 PM